

... denial of due process and gender-based discrimination. In more extreme cases, mothers have accused the courts of engaging in cover- ...

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Research Methods

timely checkups, attending parent-teacher conferences, and changing defenses change dramatically as the court system shifts from mother-as-nurturer to mother-as-litigant. For example, we see that the system attacks their litigation position by labeling them "abusing" the court process by bringing "too many" motions, "harmful" to social workers by making demands for more than questioning their nurturing skills, they rely on the court litigation as opposed to their caregiving. By following the case, one can see how the meaning of "maternal fitness" for itself is thus produced and situated interactionally. A mother engaged in the litigation process may begin to question her caregiving (and defending her own), she later may question the litigation process itself, making accusations of gender-based discrimination. In more extreme cases, mothers have accused the courts of engaging in cover-ups and law guarding their health even when the child welfare statements and findings and likewise the business of parental

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